

Gottman Method Cheat Sheet

The four horsemen, their antidotes, and the 7 principles

Therapist / couple reference — adapted from the Gottman Method.

THE FOUR HORSEMEN → ANTIDOTES

Horseman	Antidote
Criticism	Gentle start-up: 'I feel... about...'
Contempt	Build appreciation & respect
Defensiveness	Take responsibility
Stonewalling	Physiological self-soothing + re-engage

THE 7 PRINCIPLES (KEY)

1. Enhance love maps · 2. Nurture fondness & admiration · 3. Turn toward, not away · 4. Accept influence · 5. Solve solvable problems · 6. Manage conflict · 7. Create shared meaning.

RITUALS & REPAIR

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|---|---|
| ☐ Daily stress-reducing conversation | ☐ Emotional bank account |
| ☐ Weekly date | ☐ Rituals of connection |
| ☐ Repair attempts | |